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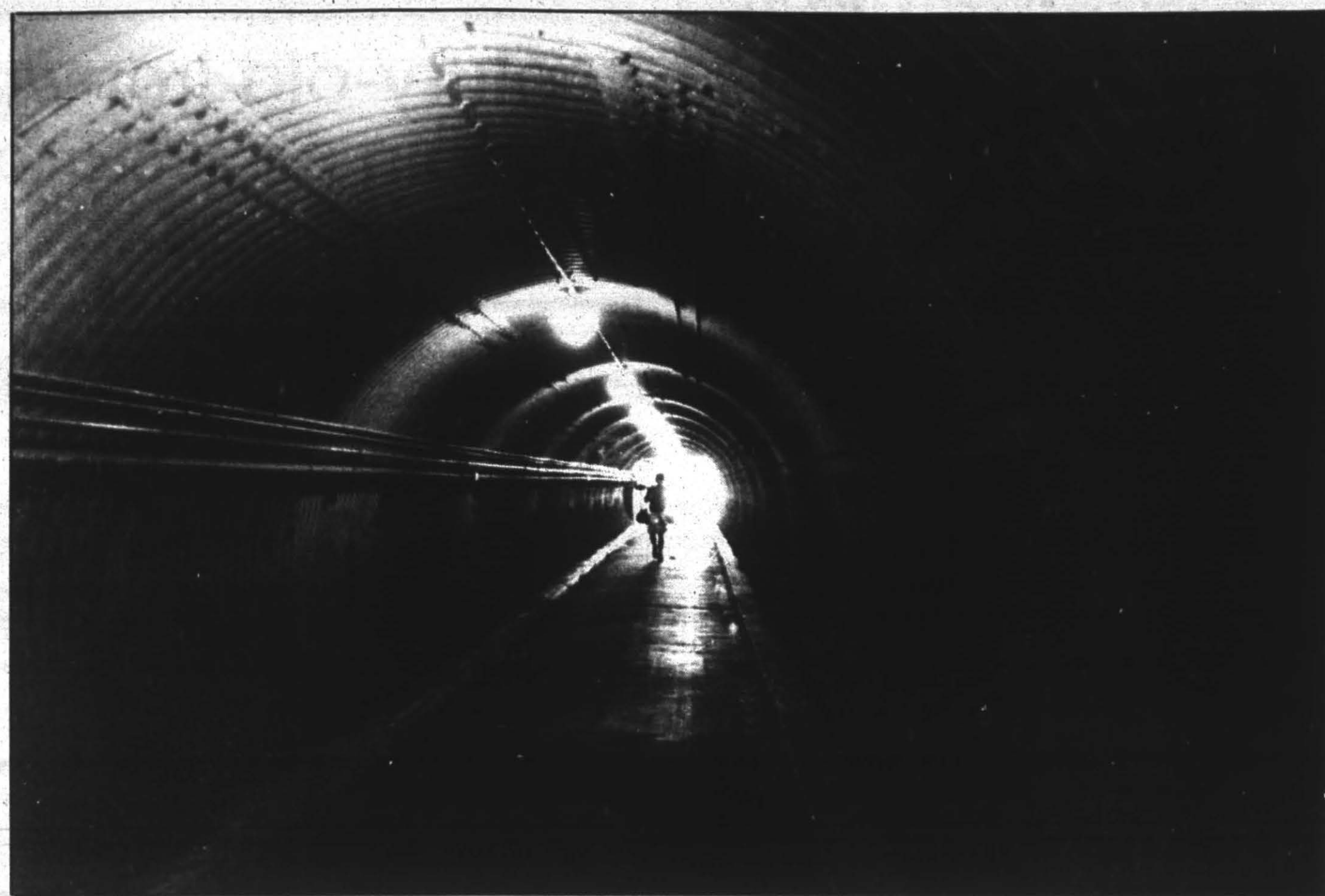
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OPINION



See the light.

Photo by Debora Dekok

CFL back in Ottawa? You must be kidding!

It's not as if we were totally caught off guard. The rumour mill was churning even before the Canadian Football League (CFL) season began three weeks ago.

But front page news, the middle of last week, announcing that a move by the Montreal Alouettes to Ottawa is a real possibility, were still startling somehow.

The Ottawa Valley hasn't even laid the Rough Riders to rest properly and already there is the chance of a "replacement" team?

To us it's incredible. We can't believe this will actually occur. But even if it only turns out to be a rumour (and a vicious one at that), it certainly serves to illuminate the pathetic state of the CFL.

Literally any football fan in Canada could have told the league "brain-trust" that putting a franchise back in Montreal wouldn't work. That was as predictable as the sun setting in the west.

Then put Larry Smith in charge and look what happens. The poor old Als have been averaging less than 8,000 fans per game at Olympic Stadium, so far this season. And if you scratch the surface you find that the vast majority of the 7,000 or so are in the yellow chairs on one "freebie" promotion or another. So how can the team survive?

Smith, the former commissioner of the CFL, is the man we finger as being directly responsible for the sorry state of this once proud league. His ill-fated push into the United States a few years ago was the beginning of the end for the CFL. The league has been in critical condition for two seasons. This year it looks as if it's headed for life support.

But imagine, after witnessing the end of the once solid Ottawa Rough Riders, this league can actually contemplate a mid-season move back to Ottawa? Of course the Rough Riders, even in the darkest days, never had a paying crowd of less than 12,000-15,000. Two seasons ago Ottawa sold 15,000 season tickets.

Evidently Ottawa's CFL history hasn't escaped some people associated with today's league. Ottawa always was (and under the right conditions might still be) a football city. There is still a potential fan base and there is definitely a first rate facility sitting without a tenant.

On the other hand Montreal, except for a brief period in the late 1970s and early 1980s, has never really been a football town. The Als have gone and then returned, in another incarnation, a couple of times.

Montreal Expos of major league baseball's National League are in serious trouble due to lack of fan support and they put a winning product on the field every season.

Hockey's Montreal Canadiens are that city's only real pro sports success story and we can't imagine any other sport surviving in Montreal, especially in the current economy. Regardless the bottom line here is the possible move to Ottawa. It just won't work!

Despite the fact Montreal is a winning team, the long suffering football fans of Ottawa and The Valley aren't likely to swallow this ill-fated notion.

First of all there is no ownership of the team here and that's a factor. But even more significant is the fact area football fans are tired of ultimatums from this league and are very unlikely to put themselves in the position of facing even more.

Most alarming for the current CFL, however, is the fact that very few people in this area seem to have noticed the Rough Riders are history. We literally haven't heard a word about them in Almonte.

The truth is that people here have had a snoot full of the CFL and trying to rescue a dying franchise from Montreal, by sticking it into Frank Clair Stadium would be doomed before it started. J.M.

Nuclear waste is a waste of space

Out of sight, out of mind.

That old saying seems to be true in the midst of the nuclear waste site proposals for Deep River. The waste will be buried deep underground in rock where no one can see it.

Then it can be forgotten.

Right? Of course not.

Everyone involved will ensure the safety of the surrounding communities will be preserved.

After all, they know exactly how safe it will be, right?

But I'm not sure what to think when I read in the Ministry of Natural Resources report, "The Siting Task Force was repeatedly requested to undertake studies of the historical health effects on residents of the historic wastes. The Siting Task Force repeatedly refused to do so, on the

"Since what may be known about God is plain to them (us), because God has made it plain to them (us). For since the creation of the world God's invisible qualities — his eternal power and divine nature — have been clearly seen, being understood from what has been made, so that men (people) are without excuse." — Romans 1:19-20

We live in an age where most of us make use of micro processors, internet, e-mail, cellular phones and probing the surface of Mars. Yet it amazes me, in this age of science and technology, how anti-intellectual we have become! This includes those outside the church of Christ and those inside it.

The 20th century has become one of the most anti-intellectual periods in the history of humanity. Think about it. Where are our great philosophers? Where are our church-shaping theologians?

We live in an age where faith and

DEVELOPING THOUGHTS

By Debora Dekok

grounds that it was not within its mandate (or budget)."

And I'm not sure what's going on when I read "This may also have the possibility of significant commercial advantages for Atomic Energy of Canada Limited," and then find out the Mayor of Deep River works there.

I should mention over 70 per cent of Deep River residents voted to ac-

cept the waste site in a referendum held two years ago.

But they're not the ones who will be affected if (when?) the radioactive waste seeps into the river and contaminates our water. They won't be around when there's an earthquake 100 or 200 years from now and the waste cannot be contained.

And they won't be around to answer the questions the following generations will have for them.



I'm not a nuclear scientist, but does it really make sense to bury something as harmful as radioactive waste in the ground? Wouldn't it make more sense to store it where it can be closely watched?

In a letter to the Minister of Natural Resources in November, the Siting Task Force recommended "the positive attitude (of the Deep River community) will dissipate if the government delays in proceeding with the project. Thus, we urge immediate consideration of our recommendations and a timely announcement of government intention."

I remember that game well from when I was a child. It's called "Quick! Before someone changes their mind."

Don't check your brain at the door

LIFE WORTH LIVING

By Rev. Matthew Dyck

reason have been unnaturally divorced. We live in an age where the common expression for an authoritative claim to truth is, "because I feel it".

What do you call someone who steadfastly and persistently refuses to acknowledge what they know to be true? Well, according to the apostle Paul, anyone who claims there is no God.

This passage from the Word of God makes it clear that the question over the existence of God is at its heart, not an intellectual problem but rather a moral one. That even if people of great learned stature such

as Carl Sagan deny the existence of God (which he does), that what they are doing is lying. And that's a moral problem.

The Bible never calls you to check your brain at the door!

Being a Christian never means sacrificing logic and reason to obtain this faith. In fact it requires you to employ it; to face what has already been made obvious to you (the existence of a Sovereign God) and logically respond to that.

"Come now, let us reason together," says the Lord.

"Though your sins are like scarlet, they shall be as white as snow;" —

Isa. 1:18 Don't check your brain at the door; Jesus is the only way to eternal life!

As a Christian nobody asked me to check my brain at the door. Still, Christians extol the virtue of a "simple faith" or "child-like faith" which becomes a faith unencumbered by complex thinking. (A "child-like" faith refers to an implicit trust in Christ).

The Bible does call us to be "babes in evil, but in understanding be mature." The Bible promotes the mind, in that it feeds the "heart". Sure you can memorize the entire Bible and never love Christ. But, can you love Christ and still know little about Him?

Let your passion in your faith be fed by what you know and let your knowledge of Christ and His Word feed your passion! The more you know Him, the more you will love Him. The more you love Him, the more you'll want to get to know Him.

LETTERS

Growth pressures hard to resist?

To the editor:

Sometimes unrelated events come together to bring opportunity for some and distress for others. Thanks to three such events, I suggest the opportunists buy shares in companies making vinyl siding, while the rest of us get ready to beat the barbarians from the gates.

Event 1. Remember amalgamation? When Almonte and Ramsay become one in January, Almonte loses the borders that have confined its growth for years.

Event 2. The Ottawa regional government has just amended its master plan to reduce urban sprawl in the rural areas of Ottawa-Carleton, including our neighbour West Carleton.

Event 3. Nortel recently announced it will add 5,000 new jobs to its complex in Kanata. Nortel is just part of a high-tech boom that is drawing affluent, young professionals to the region.

Almonte is a picturesque, little gem of a town. So far, it has escaped the vinyl-sided bungalow blight that has infected many other Ottawa satellite towns. But, with its borders gone, it

is just too tempting to remain unnoticed. It's just 20 minutes from Kanata and 35 minutes from downtown. So, with Ottawa making it tough on developers and with thousands of young professionals looking for a nice place to live, we can expect some strong growth pressures in the next few years.

Unless we can get our local politicians to take a stand — and I doubt they have the will, sophistication or stamina to hold developers at bay, Almonte will look like Carleton Place in a few years, an ugly suburban donut surrounding a charming, but fading centre.

Shaun McLaughlin
Ramsay Township

Gun law sets bad precedent

Dear editor:

Through the continuing debate re C-68, there are three main issues.

One, the Liberal government needed an issue with no real solution, and yet low vote impact to draw attention away from their three points of failure: the GST is still here, the jobs aren't and to prove their promise of no Constitutional debate, they almost lost the country.

Two, C-68 is being passed with a governmental rider that gives the inner core carte blanche to change the law at anytime, for any reason, without any parliamentary or voter review. It's a very dangerous precedent, that is bound to be repeated.

Three, last and certainly not least, on the day C-68 completes its phase in, tens if not hundreds of thousands of Canadians will become legislative criminals for possessing unregistered firearms. Canadians are masters of passive resistance. Just as they build the underground economy after the GST came in, so they will make their own decisions about their individual level of compliance to C-68.

The emotions behind firearms will never be settled. However, the legislative criminalization of a large segment of any nation's presently law-abiding citizens is a concern for everyone.

Regards,
Rick Kwissa
Carleton Place

Local efforts help needy in world

To the editor:

Thanks to the commitment of

young people from Almonte and area, families in Senegal will soon have clean water, in Uganda the World Vision's Trauma Centre will provide children of war with clothes, shelter, food and counselling, and in Thailand young girls will be given education and training so they can be spared a life of prostitution.

Those efforts are all being funded because young people from your community raised \$690 in the 1997 World Vision 30 Hour Famine. Participants consumed only clear fluids for 30 hours while raising money to support World Vision's relief and development programs. Thus far, Canadian young people have raised \$1.5 million in this year's famine.

These young people can hold their heads high because their efforts have helped shape a brighter future for the world's children. On behalf of World Vision Canada and the children who will benefit from their caring, I say "Thank you, Almonte and area."

Sincerely,
Dave Toyen
President
World Vision Canada

See page 5